

generative ai is ruining the environment

Posted by u/satancornchip • 0 points • 6 comments

i thought this was common knowledge but like,, generative ai is bad for the environment. [https://news.mit.edu/2025/explained-generative-ai-environmental-impact-0117] (https://news.mit.edu/2025/explained-generative-ai-environmental-impact-0117) theres also SO many questionable ethical implications that come with the rising popularity of it. idk im just surprised that no one else is talking about it on here

Comments

u/Vodka_-Vodka • 1 points • 2026-01-21 14:41 UTC

It is not that simple. Training large models has real costs, but everyday use is a much smaller slice and often framed without context. I usually double check claims with cited sources using tools like AlchemistAiOfficial so it is easier to separate real impact from alarmism.

u/Liemodeus_light • 1 points • 2026-01-12 05:05 UTC

anti's failing to research, yet again...

u/MaximumPackage2914 • 1 points • 2026-01-12 03:24 UTC

Wdym no one? I just brain hurt myself someone that kept insisting that immersion cooling uses water here to make a point about how water cooling pollutes water with heavy metals last night.

u/MysteriousPepper8908 • 6 points • 2026-01-12 03:16 UTC

This article is highly outdated and using information that was outdated at the time. The damn thing name drops GPT-3 so that's how ancient this information is. All it really has is information on data centers which are used far more for social media and streaming than they are for AI but apparently we weren't concerned about that until it was being used for an application that we don't personally care for. The idea that AI was largely going to be propelled by massive scaling wasn't particularly true then and the year that has past since this article was published has continued to prove that. Yes, a service used by billions of people will use a considerable amount of water and electricity but far less than other industries which provide far less value. It gets talked about plenty here, with similar articles conflating AI with data centers as a whole and using scary numbers out of context to make the problem seem more severe than it actually is.

u/satancornchip • 1 points • 2026-01-18 05:25 UTC

the issue is that ai data centers require much more processing power than social media data centers would. traditional data centers run on cpu, and ai data centers use a gpu, also likely why gpu prices have skyrocketed recently. gpus require a higher processing power, and therefore, more water is consumed.

[<https://www.rcrwireless.com/20250327/fundamentals/ai-data-center-difference>]

(<https://www.rcrwireless.com/20250327/fundamentals/ai-data-center-difference>)

<https://www.vice.com/en/article/new-report-suggests-phased-price-hikes-for-amd-and-nvidia-gpus-in-2026/>

u/MysteriousPepper8908 • 1 points • 2026-01-18 14:36 UTC

Yes, the demand for more GPUs has increased the price of GPUs but there is still no comparison between the water and energy demands of social media and video streaming and AI, those services use way more resources. They are also typically operating at a larger scale so that may change in the future but generating more heat per computation doesn't make them generally more significant consumers of water or electricity.

u/satancornchip • 1 points • 2026-01-18 05:19 UTC

the issue is that ai data centers require much more processing power than social media data centers would. social media data centers run on cpu, and ai data centers use a gpu, also likely why gpu prices have skyrocketed recently. gpus require a higher processing power, and therefore, more water is consumed.

u/FlashyNeedleworker66 • 9 points • 2026-01-12 03:16 UTC

Did you read the article? It definitely doesn't say it's ruin at any point. It notes the datacenters that are used for everything else online too, of which AI datacenters are a minority of, **including this social media platform**.

It's also been discussed not only in topic on this sub, but on that exact article.

So I guess the first question is now that you know the many questionable ethical implications of posting on a website hosted on Amazon's datacenters (which are specifically called out in your article) how can you hurt the environment by being on reddit?

u/lagoInTheLight • 2 points • 2026-01-12 03:15 UTC

Low-effort bait post....

u/jiir0 • 1 points • 2026-01-12 03:12 UTC

<https://www.weforum.org/stories/2024/02/ai-combat-climate-change/>

u/DaylightDarkle • 4 points • 2026-01-12 03:12 UTC

>im just surprised that no one else is talking about it on here

Did ya look?